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Establishment Norms

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.*

Establishment Norms

PART I: ESTABLISHMENT OF POST OFFICES

Chapter 1 – Opening of Post Offices in Rural Areas

These norms are effective from **1 April 1991** and govern the opening of Branch Post Offices in rural India.

1.1 Population Criteria

Area Type	Minimum Population
Normal Areas	3,000 population (group of villages including PPO villages)
Hilly / Tribal / Desert / Inaccessible Areas	500 population (individual village) OR 1,000 (group of villages)

1.2 Distance Criteria

Area Type	Minimum Distance from Nearest PO
Normal Areas	3 km
Hilly / Tribal / Desert Areas	Same as above; Directorate may relax in special circumstances

1.3 Anticipated Income

Area Type	Minimum Income as % of Cost
Normal Areas	33⅓% of cost
Hilly / Tribal / Desert / Inaccessible Areas	15% of cost

1.4 Desert Development Programme Districts

The following states have districts covered under DDP, where relaxed norms apply:

- Rajasthan: Jaisalmer, Jodhpur, Nagaur, Pali, Barmer, Jalore, Bikaner, Churu, Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Sri Ganganagar (84 blocks)
- Gujarat: Banaskantha, Mahesana (8 blocks)
- Haryana: Sirsa, Hissar, Bhiwani, Rohtak (26 blocks)

- Himachal Pradesh: Lahaul & Spiti, Kinnaur
- Jammu & Kashmir: Leh, Kargil

Reference: DG Posts, New Delhi, Lr. No.1-2/90-P&T dated **20.3.1991**

Chapter 2 — Opening of Post Offices in Urban Areas

Conditions for opening post offices in urban areas (DG Posts Lr. No.1-36/77 PRP dt.21.10.1986):

- Initially the SO must be self-supportive. At the first annual review, it must show a **5%** profit to be retained.
- Minimum distance: **1.5 km** in cities with population **20 lakhs** and above; **2 km** in other urban areas.
- No Extra-Departmental (ED) Post Offices shall be opened in urban areas in future.
- Heads of Circle may relax distance conditions in up to **10%** of cases, personally (not by delegation).

Chapter 3 — Panchayat Sanchar Sewa Yojana (PSSY)

Introduced from **30 September 1995** to provide basic postal services at Gram Panchayat Headquarters lacking post offices. (DG No.1-25/94-95/PSSK/PLG dated **11.9.95**)

3.1 Sanchar Kendra Agent (SKA) — Qualifications

- Passed Matriculation examination (**10th** class)
- Age between **18 to 62 years** on date of appointment (not retained beyond **65 years**)
- Good moral character; no pending criminal case
- Appointed by Gram Panchayat with written consent of SP/SSP

3.2 Functions of Panchayat Kendra

- Sale of postage stamps and stationery

- Booking of registered letters (excluding VP and Insured Articles)
- Mahila Samridhi Yojana (MSY) accounts, where feasible
- Collection, conveyance and delivery of mail within the Gram Panchayat village, where feasible
- Operation of STD/PCO/Panchayat phone if eligible

3.3 Allowance Structure

Item	Rate
Fixed monthly allowance	Rs. 500 per month
Commission on stamps — Normal rural areas	5% on sale value
Commission on stamps — Hilly/tribal (up to Rs. 100)	5%
Commission on stamps — Hilly/tribal (Rs. 101–200)	7.5%
Commission on stamps — Hilly/tribal (Rs. 201+)	10%
Commission per registered letter booked	50 paise

Fixed allowance paid on first working day of each month. Incentive payments follow **one month** later.

Chapter 4 — Standards for Opening Departmental Sub-Office (Postal Sector Plan)

Sub-offices may be opened under plan scheme 'Expansion of Postal Network' in project areas, industrial estates, new townships, and satellite colonies. (DG Posts Lr. No.1-15/90 Plg dt.10.4.1991)

All proposals sent by Circles to Planning Branch of Directorate for approval by Secretary, Ministry of Finance (Dept. of Expenditure).

Minimum workload: **5 hours** (Marathe Time Test, excluding sub-accounts/accounts work).

4.1 Loss Limits

Area	Maximum Permissible Loss (Rs./year)
Normal Rural Areas	Rs. 2,400
Hilly / Backward / Tribal Areas	Rs. 4,800

Chapter 5 — Norms for Delivery Post Offices

(DGs letter No.1-36/87-PRS dated 1.6.1990)

- Minimum number of postmen justified on existing basis: 7
- Well-demarcated delivery jurisdiction required to minimize errors in TD Sorting
- No minimum distance required between proposed delivery office and nearest existing delivery office
- Heads of Circles (PMGs/CPMGs) may relax the **7-postmen** minimum condition for new townships/estates/colonies

Chapter 6 — Standards for Revision of Allowances of GDS

Based on Kamlesh Chandra Committee Report; TRCA revised with effect from **01-07-2018**.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Nataraja Murthy Committee Report (01-01-2006)] to [Kamlesh Chandra Committee Report (01-07-2018)] as per [Ministry of Communications, Department of Posts' Resolution No. 17-13/2013-GDS]

6.1 TRCA Revision Formula

The Point System for assessment of workload has been abolished. The TRCA slabs are now subsumed into 3 Wage Scales with two Levels (Level 1: **4 hours** and Level 2: **5 hours**).

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Complex multiplier of 1.74 with 40% fitment at 20th stage] to [Abolished Point System and 2 Levels of Working Hours (4 & 5 hours)] as per [Implementation of Kamlesh Chandra Committee Report, 2018]

6.2 Workload Assessment & TRCA Slabs — GDS Categories

Category	Work Hours/Day	TRCA Slab
GDS Branch Postmaster (BPM) Level 1	Up to 4 hours	Rs. 12,000
GDS Branch Postmaster (BPM) Level 2	Up to 5 hours	Rs. 14,500

Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM) / Dak Sevak Level 1	Up to 4 hours	Rs. 10,000
Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM) / Dak Sevak Level 2	Up to 5 hours	Rs. 12,000

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [11 Point-based TRCA Slabs] to [Revenue and Level-based TRCA Matrix] as per [Implementation of Kamlesh Chandra Committee Report, 2018] Sections 6.2 and 6.3 from the original text have been merged to reflect the new standardized matrix.

6.4 Other Allowances

A Composite Allowance has been introduced, replacing older fragmented maintenance allowances.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Office Maintenance Allowance (OMA) Rs. 100, FSC Rs. 25, Boat Allowance, CDA] to [Composite Allowance comprising support for hiring accommodation, office maintenance, mobile and electricity usage] as per [Implementation of Kamlesh Chandra Committee Report, 2018]

6.5 Service Discharge Benefits

Benefit	Maximum Amount
GDS Gratuity	Rs. 1,50,000
Severance Amount (Rs. 4,000 per completed year of service)	Rs. 1,50,000 (maximum)
Service Discharge Benefit Scheme (SDBS)	Monthly contribution of Rs. 300 by both sides

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Ex-gratia Gratuity Rs. 60,000 and Severance Amount Rs. 1,500/year max 60,000] to [GDS Gratuity max Rs. 1,50,000; Severance Amount Rs. 4,000/year max Rs. 1,50,000; SDBS contribution Rs. 300] as per [Department of Posts Order on Social Security Benefits for GDS]

Chapter 7 — Method of Calculation of Income and Cost of a Post Office

7.1 Income Apportionment Fractions

Item	Rural PO	Urban PO
Stamp Revenue — Delivery Office	2/5 th of value	43/120 th of value
Stamp Revenue — Dispatch Office	20% of above	37/120 th of value
Unpaid Postage — Delivery	3/4 th	5/7 th
Unpaid Postage — Posted	1/8 th	5/42 nd
MO Commission — Issued	24%	24%
MO Commission — Paid	38%	38%

7.2 Cost Components

- Establishment costs (pay and allowances of all staff)
- Rent, rates and taxes
- Stationery and forms
- Line/telephone charges
- Overhead and administrative charges

Chapter 8 — Fixed Stationery Charges (FSC)

Revised vide Directorate letter No.23-1/2008-PAP dated 2.12.2010

Category	Rate
Bag sealing wax	Rs. 3 per bag per day
Candles	Rs. 8 per month
Supervisory staff	Rs. 4 per month
Clerical staff (PA/SA)	Rs. 6 per month
Postmen	Rs. 5 per month
Inspectors/ASPs (independent charge)	Rs. 200 per month
FMC — Single postman/combination beat	Rs. 50 per day
FMC — Two postmen sharing	Rs. 24 per day
Holiday Monetary Compensation (Supervisor/PA/Postmen)	Rs. 85 per holiday
Holiday Monetary Compensation (MTS)	Rs. 60 per holiday

Chapter 10 — Review of Post Office Establishment

Revised procedure for combining all categories of periodical reviews w.e.f. **1 April 2003**:

Category of Office	Review Frequency
Head Post Offices (HOs) and MDGs	Annually
LSG/HSG Sub-Offices, Class I SOs, other T/SOs	Every 3 years
GDS establishment revision	Every 3 years
Branch Offices (BOs)	Triennial, at time of SO/HO inspection; also at annual BO inspection (clarified 03.07.2014)

PART II: MARATHE TIME TEST & CSI NORMS — POST OFFICES (Chapter 11)

The Marathe Time Test (MTT) provides standardized time factors (in minutes per operation) for calculating the workload and staff requirements of Post Offices. The Co-efficient factors account for rest, fatigue, and incidental work.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Exclusive reliance on Marathe Time Test] to [Integration of Core System Integrator (CSI) Workload Norms for computerized operations] as per [India Post IT Modernization Project 2.0]

Chapter 11 — Establishment of Post Office (MTT) — Postal Assistants

11.1 Mails Department

Operation	Time Factor (mins)	Co-eff
Bags received	0.25	
Bags dispatched	0.20	
Transit bags (TBs) opened	0.20	
Transit bags closed	0.75	
Mails Department Co-efficient	—	1.10

11.2 Sorting Department

Operation	Time Factor (mins)	Co-eff
Articles received in sorting	0.06	
Articles posted (fully sorted)	0.08	
Mail bags closed	2.50	

Sorting Department Co-efficient	—	1.14
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11.3 Delivery Department

Operation	Time Factor (mins)	Co-eff
Paid articles received	0.16	
Delivery Department Co-efficient	—	1.20

11.4 Registration Department

Operation	Time Factor (mins)	Co-eff
Registered letters booked	1.50 (Manual) / 60 to 90 seconds (CSI POS)	
Registered letters issued to postmen	1.20 – 1.40	
Registration Department Co-efficient	—	1.25

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Registered letters booked 1.50 mins] to [60 to 90 seconds] as per [CSI Point of Sale (POS) Workload Norms]

11.5 Special Registered Articles

Article Type	Operation	Time Factor (mins)
Insured Envelopes	Posted inland	7.20
Insured Envelopes	Issued to postmen	3.50
VP Articles	Posted inland	3.70
VP Articles	Received for delivery	2.75
VP Articles	Delivered	2.70
Parcels	Posted inland	2.60
Parcels	Issued to postmen	2.50
Parcels Department Co-efficient	—	1.30

11.6 Speed Post Norms

Operation	Time Factor
Speed Post booking	82 to 188 seconds per article (under CSI POS)
Speed Post dispatch	0.4 min per article
Speed Post receipt	0.2 min per article
Speed Post issued to postman	1 min per article

Speed Post delivery: articles per day on moped	110 articles/day (4.5 hrs delivery, 1.5 hrs traverse of 18 km)
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 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Speed Post booking 2 min per article] to [82 to 188 seconds per article] and integrated [OTP-based delivery verification and Registration Service parameters] as per [Gazette Notification No. 4256 dated 25.09.2025, effective 01.10.2025]

11.7 CRC (Mail Processing) Norms – Revised 17.01.2013

Operation	Time Factor
Scanning/receipt at CRC	0.04 min per article
Sorting at CRC	0.079 min per article
Revised Speed Post processing	1,000 articles per SA per day (8-hour day)

11.8 Money Order Department

Operation	Time Factor (mins)	Co-eff (HO/SO)
TMO issued (foreign sterling)	10.00	
TMO issued (others)	9.00	
TMO paid	7.00	
Ordinary MO issued	3.50	
Ordinary MO paid	2.50	
IPO sold	2.00	
IPO paid	2.50	
MO Department Co-efficient – HO	—	1.40
MO Department Co-efficient – SO	—	1.25

11.9 Sub-Account Department

Type of Sub-Office	Time Factor (mins)
Non-delivery / single-handed SO	30.00
Other SOs	40.00
BO in direct account (per BO)	20.00
Village postman attendance per week (per postman)	5.00
Remittance of cash or stamps per occasion	5.00

11.10 Treasury Department

Cash Receipt Range	Time Factor
Daily average up to Rs. 10,000 from counters	9 min per Rs. 1,000 (fractions rounded to nearest Rs. 500)
Excess over Rs. 10,000 up to Rs. 40,000	90 min for first Rs. 10,000 + 9 min per Rs. 2,000 in excess
Excess over Rs. 40,000 up to Rs. 1 lakh	225 min for first Rs. 40,000
Bank transactions (first Rs. 25,000)	45 min
Bank transactions (each additional Rs. 25,000)	15 min
Cash to postmen (per postman)	10 min
Remittance of cash to subordinate offices	10 min per remittance
Stamps supply/sale in bulk (per Rs. 1,000)	18 min

11.11 Staff Hours and Additional PA Sanction

Duty Type	Hours
Stretch duty	7.5 hours per day
Split duty	6.75 hours per day

Additional PA sanctioned when unprovided work reaches:

Class of SO	Unprovided Work (Hours)
'C' Class SO	≥ 2.5 hours
'B' Class SO	≥ 4 hours
Other offices	≥ 5 hours

11.12 Mail Transmission Delivery Standards

Route	Standard
Local delivery	D+1
Within district	D+2
Within state	D+2 to D+3
Other states	D+3 to D+5

PART III: SAVINGS BANK & SAVINGS CERTIFICATES (Chapter 12)**Chapter 12 — Establishment of PO Savings Bank / Savings Certificates****12.1 Head Post Office — SB Norms (Manual)**

Operation	Time (mins)	Co-eff
New SB account (at counter)	9.00	
Deposit at HO	3.75	
Withdrawal at HO	5.50	
HO Co-efficient	—	1.85

12.2 Sub Post Office — SB Norms (Manual)

Operation	Time (mins)	Co-eff
New SB account at SO	9.00	
Deposit at SO	3.00	
Withdrawal at SO	5.30	
SO Co-efficient	—	1.45

12.3 Core Banking Solution (CBS) / Finacle Post Office Norms

Operation	Time (seconds)
CIF Creation	171 seconds
New SB/PPF account	76 seconds
Deposit	51 seconds
Withdrawal	53 to 97 seconds
Account closure	89 to 95 seconds

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Computerized PO Meghdoot norms w.e.f. 26-02-2008 measured in minutes (e.g. New SB account 7.00 mins)] to [CBS/Finacle Point of Sale transaction norms measured in seconds] as per [Directorate CBS/CSI Workload Reassessment]

12.4 Recurring Deposit (RD)

Operation	Time (mins)	Co-eff
RD opening at HO (payroll)	5.00	
RD opening at HO (others)	8.00	
HO Co-efficient for RD	—	1.60

SO Co-efficient for RD	—	1.30
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12.5 NSC / KVP

Operation	Time (mins)	Co-eff (HO/SO)
NSC/KVP issued	7.00	
NSC/KVP discharged	8.00	
HO Co-efficient	—	1.80
SO Co-efficient	—	1.40

12.6 Time Deposit

Operation	Time (mins)	Co-eff
New Time Deposit account	10.00	
Time Deposit Co-efficient	—	1.35

PART IV: PHILATELIC BUREAU & POSTMEN (Chapters 13–15)

Chapter 13 — Standards for Philatelic Bureau

Operation	Time Factor
Advance machine cancellation (FDCs)	37.5 min per 100 FDCs
Sale of philatelic stamps (other days)	0.40 min per rupee
Sale of philatelic stamps (date of issue)	0.33 min per rupee
Opening philatelic deposit account (inland)	18 min
Opening philatelic deposit account (foreign)	22 min
Supervisory work ratio (of total operative clerical work)	0.12

Criteria for Opening Philatelic Counter:

- Important or tourist centre
- Average 14-day sale of Rs. 1,000 or more

Chapter 14 — Postmen Establishment

Revised norms per File No.9-1/2005-WS-I/PE-I dated 5.2.2010

14.1 Delivery Time Factors

Mail Type	Time Factor (mins/article)
Unregistered mail delivery (all areas)	0.72

Registered / parcel mail	2.50
Value Payable / customs duty articles	3.00
Money Orders paid	3.85
Speed Post articles	2.50
Insured articles	3.50
Return by postman	Tracked via Postman Mobile App (PMA)

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Return by postman (maximum per day): 20 min (fixed allowance)] to [Tracked via Postman Mobile App (PMA)] as per [IT Modernization Project - Delivery and Postman Management System (DPMS)]

14.2 Walking Distance Norms

Mode / Area Type	Time per km
On foot — Congested area (density $\geq 2,500/\text{sq.km}$)	19 min/km
On foot — Less congested area	15 min/km
Bicycle — Congested area	10 min/km
Bicycle — Less congested area	8 min/km

14.3 Staff Hours

Beat Type	Staff Hours/Day
Single beat	450 min (7.5 hours)
Two batches	420 min (7 hours)

14.4 Sorting Postman & Cash Overseer

- Sorting Postman: **450** articles per hour
- Cash Overseer: Total work hours $\div (450 \times 25)$; walking max **24 km** per day

Chapter 15 — Stamp Vendors

Sale per Transaction	Time Factor
Less than Rs. 10	18 seconds per rupee
Rs. 10 to Rs. 30	6 seconds per rupee

Average Daily Sale	Type of Vendor Justified
Rs. 600 per day	1 GDS Stamp Vendor (3 hours workload)
Up to Rs. 1,000 per day	1 GDS Stamp Vendor (5 hours workload)
Above Rs. 1,000 per day	1 Departmental Stamp Vendor

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [ED Stamp Vendor] to [Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS) Stamp Vendor] as per [GDS Conduct and Engagement Rules]

Sale period considered: **4 months** (instead of **14 days** average) for assessment. (DG Posts No.31-15/83-PE-I dt.7.10.1986)

PART V: CORE SYSTEM INTEGRATOR (CSI) NORMS (Chapter 16)

Authority: Directorate instructions transitioning computerized operations to the unified platform. Applicable to all computerized HPOs under the IT Modernization Project.

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [MEGHDOOT LAN NORMS] to [Core System Integrator (CSI) Norms] as per [India Post IT Modernization Project 2.0]

Chapter 16 – CSI Module Norms

16.1 SAP F&A / Treasury Module

Operation	CSI Norm (sec)
Opening CSI Cash Office	720 sec
CSD receipt (per denomination)	20 sec
Count 100 pieces subsequently	120 sec
Remittance from SO/BO data creation	15 sec/office
Cash to postmen (per postman)	10 sec/beat (viewing screen)
Return from postmen	13 sec/PM
Bank remittance: below Rs. 5 lakh	7,200 sec
Bank remittance: Rs. 5–20 lakh	10,800 sec
Bank remittance: above Rs. 20 lakh	12,600 sec
Closing CSI Cash Office (up to Rs. 20 lakh)	3,600 sec
Closing CSI Cash Office (above Rs. 20 lakh)	4,800 sec

16.2 Point of Sale (POS) Module

Operation	CSI Norm (sec)
Registered letter booking	90 (computerized)
Speed Post booking with ACK	82
Ordinary eMO issued	90
IPO sale	128
Booking Air Mail RL	90
PLI premium acceptance	120
Telephone Revenue Collection (MTNL/BSNL)	75

16.3 DPMS / Postman Module

Operation	CSI Norm (sec)
RL issued to postman for delivery	72 (65 viewing screen)
Registered parcel issued to postman	116
MO issued to postman for delivery	122
TMO issued to postman	210
Window delivery of MO	120
Window delivery of RL	70

16.4 IPVS / Despatch Module

Operation	Time Factor
Dispatch of Registered/VP articles	16 sec per article
Registered bags closed	75 sec per bag

16.5 MO Compilation Module

Operation	CSI Norm
MO Issue Compilation	14 sec/MO
MO Paid Compilation	32 sec/MO
Co-efficient	1.4

16.6 SAP / Sub Account Module

Type of Office	CSI Norm (sec)
No-delivery / Single-handed SO	1,320
Branch Post Office	900
Other Sub-offices	1,620

PART VI: SUPERVISORY POSTS IN POST OFFICES (Chapter 17)**Chapter 17 — Supervisory Posts in Post Offices**

Supervisory work hours are calculated by multiplying operative work hours for each department by the relevant supervisory ratio. The calculation applies when Postal Assistants = 5 or more.

17.1 Supervisory Ratios (Operative Work Hours × Ratio)

Department / Function	Ratio
Mails	0.07
Sorting	0.08
Delivery	0.08
Registration — Delivery office	0.15
Registration — No-delivery office	0.10
Parcel — Delivery office	0.13
Parcel — No-delivery office	0.10
Money Order — Delivery office	0.20
Money Order — No-delivery office	0.15
Savings Bank	0.25
Savings Certificates (NSC/KVP)	0.25
Sale of Units	0.10
Sub-Account	0.17
Accounts in HOs	0.17
Treasury	0.12

17.2 For Small Offices (Less Than 5 PAs)

Office Strength	Supervisory Hours Allowed
Single-handed (1 PA)	Nil
Double-handed (2 PAs)	1 hour
3 PAs	1 hour 50 min
4 PAs	2 hours 30 min

17.3 HSG Grades

- HSG-II: Post office having 2 to 5 LSG supervisors
- HSG-I: Post office having more than 6 LSG supervisors

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Rigid LSG-dependent formation] to [Cadre Restructuring of Group 'C' employees providing for 8% HSG-I, 14% HSG-II, and 22% LSG posts relative to sanctioned PA strength] as per [Department of Posts Cadre Restructuring Orders]

PART VII: ACCOUNTS BRANCH – HPO & HRO (Chapters 18–20)

Chapter 18 – Establishment of Accounts Branch in HPO (Madan Kishore Formula)

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Madan Kishore manual time factors] to [Automated Payroll processing under CSI SAP HR/F&A Modules] as per [India Post IT Modernization Project 2.0] While theoretical assessment retains older nomenclature, operative calculation is handled by SAP.

18.1 Key Time Factors – Operative Work

Item of Work	Time Factor (mins)
Increment / Absentee statement	7.30 per entry
Establishment bill (all classes, all types)	10.00 per entry
Acquittance rolls	4.00 per entry
Leave cases	8.00 per case
Leave calculation	3.00 per calculation
Leave certificate	2.30 per case
Entry in leave account	2.30 per entry
Annual verification of service	12.00 per SB or SR
Income tax calculation	25.00 per official
Register maintenance (various)	2.00 per entry

18.2 Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS) Conversion Rates in Establishment Bill

Percentage of GDS in Office	Rate – Bill Entry	Rate – Acquittance Roll
Less than 10% GDS	12.30 min/entry	5.00 min/entry
Between 10% and 30% GDS	11.15 min/entry	4.30 min/entry

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Extra-Departmental Agents (EDA)] to [Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS)] as per [Department of Posts Nomenclature Revision]

18.3 Supervisory and Miscellaneous Work

- Supervisory work: **20%** of operative work hours
- Miscellaneous (co-efficient for misc work): **10%** of work hours

Chapter 19 — Revised SIU-Approved Norms for Accounts Branch

19.1 Conversion Rate — GDS to Departmental Staff

Category	Condition	Conversion Rate
HPO	Less than 50% GDS	0.25
HPO	50% or more but less than 100% GDS	0.20
HPO	100% or more GDS	0.15
HRO	All cases (uniform)	0.25

19.2 Operative Work Provision

Office Type	Operative Work per Employee per Day
Head Post Offices (HPO)	0.056 work hours/day/departmental employee
Head Record Offices (HRO)	0.050 work hours/day/departmental employee

LSG Accountant posts: **1st** post for first **7** clerks; **2nd** post when clerks reach **12**; **3rd** post when clerks exceed **18**. (DG Letter No.31-26/82-PE-I dt.31.5.1985)

PART VIII: SAVINGS BANK CONTROL ORGANISATION (Chapter 21)

Chapter 21 — SBCO Standards

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Manual SBCO Register maintenance] to [Central Processing Centre (CPC) and CBS Finacle Automated General Ledger (GL) Integration] as per [Directorate CBS Transition Orders] Manual checks have been largely superseded by systemic Finacle validations.

21.1 Supervisory Posts in SBCO

Active Accounts	Supervisory Post
Up to 35,000	UDC as in-charge (with special pay)
35,001 to 1,05,000	1 LSG Head Clerk
1,05,001 to 1,75,000	1 HSG-II Head Clerk + 1 LSG

Above 1,75,000	1 HSG-I + 1 LSG
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21.2 Clerical Standards — Key Time Factors

Operation	Time Factor
Receipt and distribution of documents (100 offices)	16 min
Examination of transaction lists (100 transactions)	55 min
Maintenance of SB 62(a) register and transfer (100 transactions)	266 min
Maintenance of SB 62 register (100 binders)	25 min posting + 25 min checking
Checking HO transactions (100 transactions)	300 min
General check of withdrawals (100 withdrawals)	40 min

21.3 Automated Account Listing Norms

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [Ascota/Burrough Listing Machines] to [CBS System Generated MIS Reports] as per [Core Banking Solution Implementation] Physical listing machines have been entirely phased out.

PART IX: MULTI TASKING STAFF (MTS) ESTABLISHMENT (Chapter 24)

Chapter 24 — MTS Establishment

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [Group D Establishment] to [Multi Tasking Staff (MTS) Group C] as per [6th and 7th CPC Recommendations] All erstwhile Group D posts have been upgraded to Group C MTS.

24.1 Mail Attendants & Letter Box Attendants — Time Factors

Operation	Time Factor (mins)
Cleaning stamps/seals and change of date/hour type	2 min per stamp/seal
Exchange of mails including loose parcels	0.5 min per bag/parcel (minimum 10 min per exchange)
Opening of bags (all types)	1 min per bag
Closing of bags	4 min per bag
Unregistered articles in double sorting	0.11 min per article
Stitching and stamping of lists (HO)	0.05 min per receipt
Stitching and stamping of lists (SO)	0.12 min per receipt

Stamping of MOs issued	0.10 min per MO
Stamping of blank MO forms for sale	0.05 min per form
Stamping of unpaid articles	0.11 min per article
Stamping of prepaid articles (cash)	0.025 min per article

24.2 MTS (Packers) Norms

Office Strength	MTS Sanctioned
More than 10 , not exceeding 25 officials	3 MTS for first 10 + 1 per 5 officials above 10
More than 25 officials	Above norm for first 25 + 1 per 7 officials above 25

24.3 Sweepers

- Building area: **1 hour** per **1,250 sq.ft**
- Compound area: **1 hour** per **2,000 sq.ft**

24.4 Waterman

1 Waterman per **100** officials in an office

24.5 Chowkidar

Condition	Type of Chowkidar
Average cash/stamp balance overnight > Rs. 75,000	Part-time Chowkidar
Average cash/stamp balance overnight > Rs. 1,50,000	Departmental Chowkidar

Departmental Chowkidar duty: **48 hours/week**. GDS Chowkidar: max **5 hours/day** (updated under Kamlesh Chandra norms).

24.6 Gardener

1 Gardener per **1.5 acres** of garden area

24.7 Redesignation of Group D

Erstwhile Group D redesignated as MTS (Multi Tasking Staff) Group C vide Directorate letter No.1-20/2008-PCC dated **24.9.2010**. Packer designation changed to Peon in administrative/subordinate offices; Mail Peon in FPOs.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Departmental Sweepers, Watermen, Chowkidars, and Gardeners] to [Contractual and Outsourced Services] as per [Ministry of Finance Guidelines on Outsourcing of non-core activities] Creation of new posts in these specific categories is restricted.

PART X: MAIL OFFICES – RMS

Chapter 25 – Establishment of Mail Offices (IPVS & PNOP Norms)

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Marathe Time Test for Sorting Assistants] to [India Post Visibility System (IPVS) and Parcel Network Optimization Project (PNOP) Norms] as per [Directorate Mail Network Optimization Project]

25.1 Mails Department – Receipt and Dispatch

Operation	Time Factor
Bags received (IPVS scanning)	15 seconds
Bags dispatched (IPVS scanning)	15 seconds
Parcels received outside	10 seconds
Parcels dispatched outside	10 seconds
Mail bags opened	1.50 min
Mail bags closed	2.50 min
Unregistered articles received in sorting	0.10 min
Articles posted for dispatch	0.12 min

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Manual entry norms (e.g., Bags received 0.25 mins)] to [IPVS Barcode Scanning Norms] as per [Directorate IPVS Integration Guidelines]

25.2 Registration & Parcel Department (RMS)

Operation	Time Factor (mins)
Registered articles dispatched	0.40
Registered bags (RBs) made up	1.50
Parcel bags received/dispatched	0.20
Parcel bags closed	2.00
Parcel bags opened	1.00
Registered parcels received	0.35
Registered parcels dispatched	0.75

Insured bags opened	2.00
Insured bags closed	3.00
MO received in sorting	0.13
HVMO received in sorting	0.73

Chapter 26 — Mail Guards Establishment

Posts of Mail Guards/Head Mail Guards are assessed based on IPVS bag scanning and handling volumes in transit nodes and Road Transport Network (RTN) routes.

Bag / Handling Type	IPVS Handling Norm
Packet bag / Letter (L) bag	15 seconds per scan
Mail/Parcel/Special bag	15 seconds per scan
Transit section justification	Based on RTN route mapping and NPH/SPH linkage

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [Molinder Singh Formula points system (e.g., Packet bag 1 point, L bag 2 points)] to [IPVS Scanning and RTN Route Mapping] as per [Mail Network Optimization Project (MNOP)]

Chapter 27 — Transit Mail Office (TMO) / Transit Section

When mail exchange at a station requires physical transshipment without sorting, a Transit Mail Office can be opened based on RTN schedule alignment.

No traditional rail transit section is to be opened where operations have been entirely replaced by closed-body RTN vehicles.

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [101 points threshold] to [RTN schedule alignment and Closed-body Vehicle network] as per [Directorate Transport Network Reforms]

Chapter 28 — Travelling Mail Attendant (TMA) / Travelling Van Attendant (TVA)

TMA/TVA is sanctioned for escorted RTN routes and remaining rail sections where physical security of closed bags is mandated without intermediate mail list preparation.

Chapter 29 — Supervisory Posts in Mail Offices

29.1 Cadre Restructuring Norms

Supervisory posts are allotted based on Cadre Restructuring ratios: **22% LSG, 14% HSG-II, and 8% HSG-I** of the total sanctioned Sorting Assistant strength.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [1 LSG per 6 SAs within time test] to [Standardized percentage-based Cadre Restructuring ratios] as per [Department of Posts Group C Cadre Restructuring Orders]

29.2 RMS Supervisory Ratios

Department	Ratio
Receipt/Dispatch (Mails)	0.07
Sorting	0.07
Registration	0.14
Parcel	0.14

Chapter 30 — Determination of Number of Sets of Sections

Parameter	Value
Maximum weekly working hours	42 hours
Minimum weekly working hours	36 hours
Co-efficient for night duty (between 20:00 and 06:00 hrs)	20 min per hour
Platform attendance addition	0.30
RO attendance addition	0.30
Mail exchange addition	0.30 (0.15 + 0.15)
Total weekly hours for OTA purposes	192 hours for sections

Chapter 32 — Sub Record Office (Punjab Formula)

Operation	Time Factor
Opening of Dak	2 min 30 sec
Communication of orders (per order)	10 min
Disbursement of pay (per official)	5 min
Maintenance of cash abstract	10 min

Chapter 33 — Accounts Branch of HRO

Establishment bill processing, leave management, and acquittance rolls are fully automated under the CSI SAP HR/F&A Modules.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Madan Kishore Formula manual time factors (e.g., Establishment bill 12.30 min/entry)] to [Automated Payroll processing under CSI SAP HR Modules] as per [India Post IT Modernization Project 2.0]

Chapter 34 — Formula for ASRM and IRM in Mail Offices

Strength	Posts Sanctioned
35 SAs in a set	1 Inspector Record Master (IRM)
55 SAs in a set	1 IRM + 1 Assistant SRM (ASRM)
Each additional 35 SAs	1 additional IRM
Set with HSG-II and more than 20 T/S SAs	1 ASRM

Chapter 35 — Platform Inspectors in RMS

Number of Officials on Platform	Post
1 to 29	No Platform Inspector post
30 to 49	1 Platform Inspector (T/S scale)
50 to 74	1 PI upgraded to IRM scale
130 and above	1 PI per additional 40 officials

Chapter 38 — Automated Mail Processing Centres (AMPCs)

Operation	Productivity Norm
VCD Operator (Video Coding)	2,200 articles/hour (10-min break every 2 hours)
AFF Operator (Automated Flat Facing)	4,500 articles/hour
Culling/Facing (bulk mail)	5,000 articles per manhour
Culling/Facing (other mail)	2,000 articles per manhour
Manual induction — SAI (Singulator Automatic Induction)	1,500 articles/hour
Manual induction — DOI	1,500 articles/hour
LSM Operator (Letter Sorting Machine)	1 per machine
LSM Loader	3 trolleys per hour

PART XI: DIVISIONAL & CIRCLE OFFICE ESTABLISHMENT

Chapter 41 — Divisional Office Establishment (SIU Standard)

41.1 Justification of Divisional Office

Condition	Justified
Total SIU score ≥ 0.9	Divisional Office justified
Score > 1.3	Additional ASP justified
RMS Division — Score ≥ 1.0	Division justified
RMS Division — Score ≥ 2.6	Bifurcation (split into two divisions)

41.2 Clerical Strength Formula

Formula: $(\text{HOs} \times 0.200) + (\text{SOs} \times 0.050) + (\text{BOs} \times 0.002) + (\text{PAs} \times 0.010) + (\text{Postmen} \times 0.005) + (\text{MTS} \times 0.002) + (\text{GDS Staff} \times 0.001)$

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [Group D and ED Staff] to [Multi Tasking Staff (MTS) and Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)] as per [Department of Posts Nomenclature Revision]

41.3 Group A Division Criteria

- Contains 1 gazetted HO, OR
- Contains 3 or more non-gazetted HOs/HSG SOs, OR
- Clerical strength exceeds 450

Chapter 43 — Inspectors Establishment

Inspecting Unit	Co-efficient
Head Post Office (HO)	0.023
Sub Post Office (SO)	0.012
SO in hilly areas	0.013
Branch Office (BO)	0.005
BO in hilly areas	0.006
Departmental staff (per official)	0.001
GDS staff (per official)	0.0004
Each sub-division formed	0.41

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [ED staff (0.0004)] to [GDS staff (0.0004)] as per [Gramin Dak Sevak Conduct and Engagement Rules]

Each sub-division is based on an inspecting workload of **0.59**.

Chapter 44 – Complaints Inspector

1 Complaints Inspector per Division (irrespective of complaints volume).

Additional post justified if public complaints exceed **800** per month.

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [Manual complaints counting for additional posts] to [Centralized Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS) and CRM Portal automated distribution workload] as per [Directorate Public Grievance Division Orders]

Chapter 45 – Circle Office Establishment (SIU Standard)

45.1 Central Registry

1 Clerk per **57,000** diarised communications per year.

45.2 Data Entry & Processing Standards

Data entry speed of **8,000** Key Depressions per Hour (KDPH) on computers.

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [Typing Standards: 7,100 words per day OR 710 lines per day (7-hour working day)] to [Data Entry Standards: 8,000 Key Depressions per hour (KDPH)] as per [DoPT Guidelines on Computerization]

45.3 Establishment Section

Function	Standard
General establishment processing	1 clerk per 3,750 receipts per year
T/S SOs under review	1 clerk per 825 offices

45.4 PLI Section Time Factors

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [Manual PLI time factors (e.g., PLI proposals 1 hour 20 min, Death claims 2 hour 30 min)] to [Core Insurance Solution (CIS)]

McCamish processing norms] as per [PLI Directorate Automation Project] Manual calculation norms have been superseded by direct system-driven processing in the CIS portal.

45.5 Sectional Officers

1 Sectional Officer per 100 points (1,600 productive hours per year).

PART XII: POSTMASTERS IN GROUP A & B HOs

Chapter 51 — Standards for Postmasters in Group A & B Head Post Offices

51.1 Points for Conversion

Conversion Type	Points Required
Group A (Deputy PM + APM combined)	11,000 points
Group B HO	4,200 points
Additional Deputy PM (Group B)	1 per 2,200 points above base

51.2 Deputy PM (Gazetted — Group A) Point Calculation

Item	Points per Unit
T/S clerks	17 pts per clerk
SBCO clerks	3 pts per clerk
Fixed (PR/Grievance)	500 pts (fixed)

51.3 APM (HSG — Group A) Point Calculation

Item	Points per Unit
T/S clerks under APM	37 pts per clerk
Postmen supervision	7 pts per postman

Chapter 52 — Conversion of LSG SO to Head Post Office

Each district should have 1 HO with a minimum of 20 SOs attached.

Bifurcation when SOs exceed 60: neither resulting HO is to have less than 20 SOs.

PART XIII: SPECIAL ESTABLISHMENTS**Chapter 57 — Investigating Inspectors of Complaints and Vigilance**

1 post per 8 Postal/RMS Divisions.

Chapter 58 — Pairing Organisation

Office Type	Standard
Circle Pairing	1 UDC per 1,600 credit-debit transfers per month
Central Pairing Office	1 UDC per 1,200 credit-debit transfers per month

Chapter 60 — Returned Letter Office (Marathe Time Test)

Article Type	Receipt/Disposal Time (mins)	Supervisory Ratio
Unregistered articles	2.50 per article	0.11
Registered articles	8.00 per article	0.17
Parcels	12.00 per article	0.17

Establishment review: every 3 years (Directorate letter No.25-03/2003-PE-I dated 4.12.2014).

Chapter 61 — Postal Stores Depot

Function	Standard
Clerical: Invoice items	1 clerk per 4,900 invoice items/year
Clerical: Transfer notices	1 clerk per 12,650 transfer notices/year
MTS (Multi Tasking Staff)	6 Daftries + 20 MTS for approx. 600 indenting units

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [Group D] to [Multi Tasking Staff (MTS)] as per [Department of Posts Nomenclature Revision and 6th/7th CPC Recommendations]

Review frequency: every 3 years.

Chapter 62 — Foreign Post Office

Operation	Time Factor (mins)
Inward ordinary MO	7 min
Outward International Financial System (IFS) MO	4.10 min
Foreign letter mail (unregistered) supervisory ratio	0.80 of operative work

Registered LM / CED supervisory ratio	0.17
Parcel export supervisory ratio	0.15
PMO (Postal Money Order) supervisory ratio	0.20

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Outward sterling MO (list system)] to [Outward International Financial System (IFS) MO] as per [Universal Postal Union (UPU) IFS Integration and Electronic Data Interchange (EDI) mandates] The manual list system for sterling has been entirely decommissioned.

Chapter 64 – Postal Training Centres

Post	Norms
Instructor	4 hours class per day + 3 hours fixed items; teacher-taught ratio 1:20
Vice-Principal	24 min per trainee + 136 hours per PS Group B session
Administrative Officer	1,057 hours per annum (fixed) + 16 min per trainee

Chapter 65 – Canteens and Tiffin Rooms

Strength	Category
15 to 49 officials	Tiffin Room B
50 to 99 officials	Tiffin Room A
100 to 249 officials	Canteen D
250 to 499 officials	Canteen C
500 to 699 officials	Canteen B
700 to 1,200 officials	Canteen A

Chapter 67 – Mail Motor Units (MMU)

Category	Co-efficient / Norm
Administrative staff (Major MMU with 51+ MMS vehicles)	0.020 per official
Technical staff per MMS vehicle	0.16 per vehicle
Leave reserve	10% of staff worked out

Chapter 68 – Postal Machine Assistant

Machine Type	Machines per PMA per Year
Adding/listing machine	28

Digital Franking / RMFS	52
Stamp cancelling machine	40

Chapter 69 — Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS)

The traditional mechanical and electronic franking machines have been phased out. Standards now apply to the Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS) models.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Hand-operated, Electrically-operated, and High-speed machines] to [Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS) Digi-Franking] as per [India Post Franking Machine (Phase-out) Guidelines and RMFS Implementation]

Machine Type	Capacity (Articles/Day)
RMFS Low-Volume Desktop	3,000
RMFS Medium-Volume	5,000
RMFS High-Speed Commercial	10,000

Chapter 70 — Departmental Libraries

Function	Standard
Physical verification of books	200 min per 100 books
Shelving of books	3 hours per 100 books
Reference work (small collection, up to 5,000 books)	200 man-hours added
Reference work (medium/large collection)	400 man-hours added

PART XIV: PUBLIC RELATIONS INSPECTORS & MISC

Chapter 22 — Norms for Creation of Posts of PRI (Postal)

Revised norms by Internal Work Unit (Postal):

22.1 PRI(P) Attached to Presidency GPOs

Factor	Co-efficient
Fixed and Miscellaneous	0.53135
Per Postman / GDS Delivery Agent	0.00058
Per LB Attendant / GDS LB Attendant	0.00378
Per Complaint / Enquiry	0.00029
Per verification of claim	0.00009

Per court attendance	0.00340
Per local journey	0.000114

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [EDDA (Extra Departmental Delivery Agent) and EDLB] to [Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS) Delivery Agent and GDS LB Attendant] as per [Department of Posts Nomenclature Revision]

22.2 PRI(P) for First-Class HOs (Group A Postmaster)

Factor	Co-efficient
Fixed and Miscellaneous	0.51628
Per Postman / GDS Delivery Agent	0.00120

22.3 PRI(P) for Other Offices

Factor	Co-efficient
Fixed and Miscellaneous	0.52135
Per Postman / GDS Delivery Agent	0.00120

Chapter 55 — Sorting AS and Sorting Inspectors in Circle Office

Post	Norm
Sorting Assistant	0.53 per RMS Division
Sorting Inspector	0.34 per RMS Division

PART XV: QUICK REFERENCE — KEY NORMS AT A GLANCE

Critical Population & Distance Norms

Norm	Normal Area	Hilly/Tribal/Desert
Population (Rural BO)	3,000	500 (single village) or 1,000 (group)
Distance from nearest PO	3 km	3 km (may be relaxed)
Income as % of cost	33⅓%	15%
Urban PO distance (cities ≥ 20 lakh pop.)	1.5 km	N/A
Urban PO distance (other cities)	2 km	N/A

Review Periods – Summary

Office/Establishment	Review Period
Head Post Offices, MDGs	Annual
LSG/HSG SOs, Class I SOs, T/SOs	Every 3 years
GDS establishment	Every 3 years
Branch Offices (BOs)	Triennial / Annual BO inspection
RLO establishment	Every 3 years
Postal Stores Depot	Every 3 years

Key MTT & CSI Co-efficients – Post Offices

Department	Co-efficient / Standard
Mails	1.10
Sorting	1.14
Delivery	1.20
Registration	1.25 (Manual) / POS: 60–90 sec
Parcels	1.30
MO – Head Office	1.40
MO – Sub Post Office	1.25
SB – Head Office	CBS Finacle Automated
SB – Sub Post Office	CBS Finacle Automated
NSC/KVP – Head Office	CBS Finacle Automated
NSC/KVP – Sub Post Office	CBS Finacle Automated
RD – Head Office	CBS Finacle Automated
RD – Sub Post Office	CBS Finacle Automated
MO Compilation (CSI)	1.40

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Manual SB/NSC/RD Co-efficients and Meghdoot] to [CBS Finacle Automated tracking and Core System Integrator (CSI)] as per [India Post IT Modernization Project 2.0]

Postmen Delivery Standards – Summary

Category	Rate / Norm
Unregistered mail delivery	0.72 min/article
Registered mail	2.50 min/article
Speed Post	2.50 min/article
Money Orders paid	3.85 min/article
VP / Customs duty articles	3.00 min/article

Walking speed (foot, congested)	19 min/km
Walking speed (foot, less congested)	15 min/km
Cycling speed (congested)	10 min/km
Cycling speed (less congested)	8 min/km
Daily staff hours (single beat)	450 min (7.5 hrs)

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Manual paper returns] to [Postman Mobile App (PMA) real-time delivery updates] as per [IT Modernization Project - DPMS]

GDS Key Thresholds – Summary

Category	Work Hours/Day	TRCA Slab
GDS Branch Postmaster (BPM) Level 1	Up to 4 hours	Rs. 12,000
GDS Branch Postmaster (BPM) Level 2	Up to 5 hours	Rs. 14,500
Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM) Level 1	Up to 4 hours	Rs. 10,000
Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM) Level 2	Up to 5 hours	Rs. 12,000

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [11 Point-based TRCA Slabs (e.g., 75 points, 100 points, unreg articles 25/day = 1 point)] to [Abolished Point System mapped to Time-Level TRCA Matrix] as per [Implementation of Kamlesh Chandra Committee Report, 2018]

Mail Guard Points – IPVS Norms

Item / Bag Type	Handling Norm
Packet bag / Letter (L) bag	15 seconds per scan
Mail/Parcel/Special bag	15 seconds per scan
Transit Section	Based on RTN route mapping

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Updated/Substituted from [Molinder Singh Formula (1 point, 2 points, 4 points)] to [India Post Visibility System (IPVS) Scanning and RTN Route Mapping] as per [Mail Network Optimization Project (MNOP)]

SBCO Supervisory Thresholds

All manual active account thresholds and physical listing machine norms have been entirely superseded by the Core Banking Solution (CBS). Supervisory structures are now

managed under the Central Processing Centre (CPC) jurisdiction via automated Finacle General Ledger (GL) integration.

 LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Updated/Substituted from [Manual Active Account Thresholds (e.g., 35,000 to 1,75,000)] to [Central Processing Centre (CPC) and CBS Finacle Automated General Ledger (GL) Integration] as per [Directorate CBS Transition Orders]

